

Brightleaf Software Inc. — Employee Handbook

This handbook describes company policies on leave, remote work, expenses, and benefits. It is intended as a general reference; specific situations should be confirmed with HR.

1. Paid Time Off (PTO)

Full-time employees accrue 18 days of paid time off per calendar year, credited at a rate of 1.5 days per month of employment. PTO begins accruing from an employee's start date and may be used once accrued, with manager approval requested at least five business days in advance for planned absences.

Unused PTO carries over into the following year up to a maximum of 10 days. Any unused PTO beyond this 10-day cap is forfeited at the end of the calendar year and is not paid out, except where required by local law. Employees who leave the company will be paid out for any accrued and unused PTO up to the 10-day carryover cap, in their final paycheck.

Part-time employees working at least 20 hours per week accrue PTO on a pro-rated basis, calculated as a percentage of the full-time accrual rate equal to their average weekly hours divided by 40. Part-time employees working fewer than 20 hours per week are not eligible for accrued PTO under this policy.

2. Sick Leave

Sick leave is tracked separately from PTO. Full-time employees receive 10 sick days per calendar year, available in full starting January 1st rather than accruing monthly. Sick days do not carry over to the following year and are not paid out upon separation from the company under any circumstances.

Sick leave may be used for an employee's own illness, medical appointments, or to care for an immediate family member who is ill. For absences of three or more consecutive sick days, a note from a healthcare provider may be requested by HR before the employee returns to work.

3. Remote Work Policy

Employees in eligible roles may work remotely up to three days per week without prior approval, provided their manager is notified in advance through the team calendar. Fully remote arrangements, where an employee works from home five days per week on an ongoing basis, require written approval from both the employee's manager and HR, and are reviewed annually.

Employees working remotely from outside their home country for longer than 30 consecutive days must notify HR in advance, due to potential tax and legal implications for the company. This 30-day threshold applies per trip; there is no limit on the number of such trips per year, though HR may request additional documentation for trips occurring more than twice in a calendar year.

4. Expense Reimbursement

Business-related travel expenses, including airfare, lodging, and ground transportation, are reimbursable when incurred for approved business travel. Employees must submit an expense report with itemized receipts within 30 days of the expense being incurred. Expenses submitted more than 60 days after being incurred will not be reimbursed except in unusual circumstances approved by Finance.

Meals during business travel are reimbursable up to \$75 per day, inclusive of tax and tip. Alcohol is not reimbursable under the meal allowance under any circumstances. Client entertainment expenses, including meals with clients that may include alcohol, fall under a separate client entertainment budget and require pre-approval from a director-level manager or above.

Home office equipment, such as monitors, keyboards, and ergonomic chairs, may be reimbursed up to \$500 per employee per calendar year for employees in approved remote or hybrid arrangements. This allowance does not roll over between years and resets each January 1st regardless of how much of the prior year's allowance was used.

5. Health and Retirement Benefits

Full-time employees are eligible for company-sponsored health insurance starting on the first day of the month following 30 days of employment. The company covers 80% of the premium for the employee and 50% of the premium for any covered dependents, across all available health plan tiers.

The company offers a 401(k) retirement plan with a matching contribution of 50% of employee contributions, up to 6% of the employee's salary. Matching contributions vest immediately and are available to all full-time employees beginning on their first day of employment, with no waiting period required for the retirement plan specifically, unlike the health insurance waiting period described above.

6. Parental Leave

Employees who have worked at the company for at least 12 months are eligible for 16 weeks of paid parental leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. This leave may be taken continuously or split into two periods within the first 12 months following the qualifying event, with manager and HR approval for any split arrangement.

Employees with less than 12 months of tenure at the time of the qualifying event are eligible for 6 weeks of paid parental leave instead of the full 16 weeks. In both cases, parental leave runs concurrently with any leave required under applicable state or federal law, rather than being added on top of it.